



RYAN DAVID BROWN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Protesters in July off Hupper Island, in midcoast Maine, where Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. has spent many summers.

In His Island Retreat, the Chief Justice Finds Himself Isolated

By JODI KANTOR

PORT CLYDE, Maine — To many people on this remote stretch of Maine coastline, where every day looks like a fresh painting made of light and water, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. is just “John.”

John, who has spent over 20 summers on Hupper Island, a refuge about 90 miles northeast of Portland with no cars and barely two dozen homes. John, who swaps favors with neighbors and endures jokes about his boating skills from more experienced op-

erators. John, who has spent many mornings on the dock in Port Clyde, the postage-stamp-size town across the water from the island, nursing a half-caff and a cinnamon bun.

For a long time, the chief justice’s life here was a story of potluck dinners and easy friendships, according to a summer of interviews with more than two dozen residents. Neighbors reveled in his position but kept exchanges with him about it brief or light. At a long-ago annual summer party, he used to participate in touch football, then call dinner

Protests and Tighter Security in Maine

to order by proclaiming, “Oyez, oyez, oyez, the lobsters are ready.”

But in recent years, as the Supreme Court has reshaped American life and handed more power to President Trump, a very personal form of anger has been rising here at the chief justice, transforming his getaways.

His summer retreats, long a well-known fact, are now a source

of debate. Neighbors have taken to the water to protest him. Calling themselves “kayak-tivists,” they form flotillas facing his island home, holding waterproof signs conveying their disappointment. A local newspaper columnist recommended that people in town give him the finger.

Even some longtime friends who would not dream of joining the kayakers said they had been drawing back socially because of their distress over his decisions, notably the court’s 2024 decision granting the president broad im-

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Case at Cornell Revives Anger Far Beyond It

By STEPHANIE SAUL and EMMA GOLDBERG

A lawsuit alleging rape at a Cornell fraternity house has set off a wave of anger among women on college campuses and beyond.

Campus sexual assault survivors and their supporters have published essays in school newspapers and inundated social media in solidarity with the complainant, known in court records only as Jane Doe.

Some are using the familiar #MeToo hashtag of an earlier movement to combat sexual abuse and harassment. Others have adopted a new one: #IAmJaneDoe.

In one opinion article in the University of Pennsylvania campus newspaper, students wrote that “sexual violence happens far too often on college campuses everywhere.”

“It’s time to face the fact that the ‘Cornell incident’ isn’t just born of Cornell problems, or limited to a Cornell issue,” the students wrote.

The outrage flooding social media and rising up on campuses follows similar waves of disgust about campus sexual violence that emerged more than a decade ago and then reignited after the broader #MeToo reckoning that began with Hollywood sexual assault revelations. Driving the campaign in support of Ms. Doe is a feeling that not enough changed after similar movements.

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PHOTOGRAPHS BY ZISHAAN A LATIF FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Ruchika Sanjay Suryavanshi, left, during an inspection in Mumbai, India. Top right, Tukaram Mundhe, whose food safety campaign has captured India’s imagination. Bottom right, dirty dishes.

In India, a Food Safety Inspector Is a Rock Star

By SUHASINI RAJ and JONATHAN WOLFE

MUMBAI, India — The early-morning raid caught the staff at a popular Mumbai restaurant by surprise.

Food safety officials swept into the kitchen, scrutinizing the tandoori ovens and expiration dates on batches of butter. They quickly uncovered a number of issues. One employee was chopping ginger while sitting on the floor; another, preparing chapatis with a rolling pin, was wearing shorts.

“Why aren’t you in pants?” asked an official. But she, and

Diners Revere Him and Owners Fear Him

New York Times journalists observing the raid, were soon distracted by a group of cockroaches scurrying past an oil canister.

The inspection last month at Olympia Coffee House found scores of health and safety violations and resulted in an order to close the century-old institution. It was the latest high-profile operation spearheaded by Tukaram Mundhe, the state’s new top food

and drug official, whose zero-tolerance campaign against rogue kitchens and sloppy manufacturers has captured India’s imagination.

No business appears to escape Mr. Mundhe’s attention. His staff has inspected famed establishments such as Olympia — where Matt Damon and Tom Holland had tea this summer while promoting “The Odyssey” — as well as street vendors, government cafeterias, high-end restaurants and chains like McDonald’s.

Later that day, at the other end of the sprawling coastal city, an in-

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For Midterms, AIPAC Money Widens Divide

Eroding Coalitions With Spending for Israel

This article is by Jennifer Medina, Theodore Schleifer, Ellen Gabler and Yair Rosenberg.

Less than five years after its entry into U.S. political campaigns, the American Israel Public Affairs Committee is now one of the best-funded players in the midterm elections. It has also become one of the most polarizing.

AIPAC has raised \$233 million to support its friends and attack its perceived foes, even as public sentiment has shifted sharply against its singular cause: American support for Israel.

The group’s decision to become a major player in campaigns has alienated some former allies and left others ducking AIPAC’s support. Some candidates have worn opposition from AIPAC as a badge of honor. Some not only refuse money from AIPAC, but also refuse to accept money from its donors. The organization has increasingly become a campaign issue unto itself. This summer, Mayor Zohran Mamdani of New York described AIPAC as part of a group of “monsters” that he said were too powerful in American politics.

As AIPAC contends with its biggest crisis in years and second-guessing from even some allies, its leaders are unbowed, according to interviews with more than three dozen donors, former board members and political strategists who work with the group. They describe their mission as a long game: electing a Congress that will help combat what they see as existential threats to Israel from Iran and other hostile countries. And despite increased public criticism of both AIPAC and Israel, the group has continued to draw tens of millions in contributions that it can use to pick sides in House and Senate campaigns.

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TRUMP ORDERED PUBLIC FUNDING FOR PRAISE ADS

\$20 MILLION CAMPAIGN

President Calls Fawning Commercials P.S.A.s ‘for the Country’

This article is by Maggie Haberman, Hamed Aleaziz, Shane Goldmacher and Jonathan Swan.

WASHINGTON — President Trump personally instructed his budget director to use taxpayer money for TV ads praising him and his presidency, setting in motion a \$20 million contract that used funds from the Department of Homeland Security, according to people familiar with the matter.

The ads have run across cable and network television — on Fox News, CNN and MS Now, with football games on Fox and with national newscasts on CBS, ABC and NBC, including “Meet the Press,” which Mr. Trump is known to watch.

Mr. Trump was eager to see the laudatory ads on the air and told Russell T. Vought, the director of the Office of Management and Budget, to come up with the money from within the government, the people said. Mark Paoletta, the budget office’s counsel, and Will Scharf, the White House counsel, both said it would be legal to use D.H.S. funds. The president and Susie Wiles, the White House chief of staff, both spoke with Markwayne Mullin, the homeland security secretary, about the ads.

On Sept. 20, U.S. Customs and Border Protection — which falls under D.H.S. — awarded the contract to LMD, a Maryland marketing firm, federal records show.

This article is based on interviews with 12 people familiar with the president’s interest in the ads and how they came to be. They spoke on condition of anonymity

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Calls for Generational Change Don’t Resonate in Voting Booth

This article is by Lisa Lerer, Matt Zdzun and Ashley Wu.

In the lead-up to the midterm elections, calls for generational change have echoed through districts across the country, as younger candidates have pushed to replace the old guard.

In Massachusetts, Senator Ed Markey, 80, was diagnosed with “chronic re-election disorder” by allies of his younger primary opponent. “Doctors agree: Democracy suffers when politicians won’t pass the torch,” said an actor dressed as a doctor in an attack ad.

In Northern California, a spot denouncing Representative Mike Thompson, 75, compared the Capitol to a refrigerator, full of “career politicians” who “sit there year after year behind the pickles.” Thompson, the ad said, was “past his expiration date.”

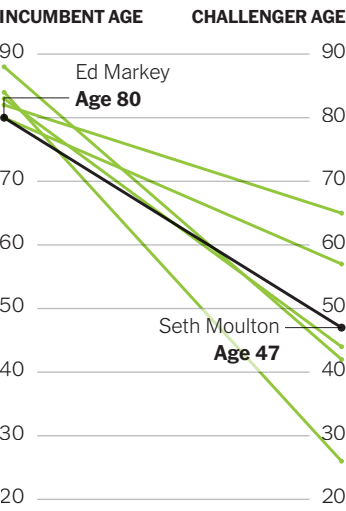
And in Mississippi, an ad featured a woman identified as a retired public-school teacher wondering about the effectiveness of Representative Bennie Thompson, 78, who has been in Congress for over three decades. “Has he made things better here?” she asked. “Absolutely not.”

And yet, the gerontocracy remains alive and well in American politics. In primary after primary, voters rejected those calls for younger leadership, voting for these and other incumbent politicians who were notably older than their challengers, according to an analysis by The New York Times.

Their wins didn’t stem from a failure by younger candidates to

Six Congressional Primary Winners Over 80

In this year’s primaries, six congressional incumbents in their 80s beat much younger challengers in single-party primaries. In one example, Ed Markey, 80, senator of Massachusetts, beat his 47-year-old challenger.



press the case: Campaign ads pushing for new, younger leadership ran in at least 77 House and Senate primary races, according to a Times analysis of data from AdImpact, a media tracking firm.

Instead, the results point to an unshakable reality of American politics: Incumbency remains a near-invincible force in congressional elections. With stronger

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Another Try for Secession?
The Parti Québécois, which could win a provincial election, has vowed to hold a referendum on independence decades after Quebec voted “no.” PAGE 4

U.S.-Iran Flashpoint
A cryptic call near a British military base used by the United States set off a counterterrorism response. PAGE 12

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Earl Caldwell was the only reporter at the motel where the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. was killed. PAGE 15



ARTS & LEISURE

Kyle MacLachlan: Not Quirky
“I feel pretty regular — kind of boring, actually,” the actor, known for eccentric roles, says. “Not that interesting.” PAGE 8

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From Prison to a Gilded Life
Pardoned by President Trump, the billionaire founder of the cryptocurrency exchange Binance now sits at the table of kings and presidents. PAGE 4

A Paradise for Creators
The streets of New York have become a popular backdrop for countless TikTok and Instagram videos. PAGE 1

SPORTS 25-28

A \$30 Million Disaster
Upset about patchy grass and dried-out greens at their restored golf course, Yale alums want answers. PAGE 25



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A Stalled Transition
The rollout of electric school buses has been rocky, rife with technical challenges, logistical headaches and resistance from voters. PAGE 8

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When It’s Time to Rebrand
A trad influencer who left her husband, questioned her beliefs and stopped selling anti-feminism T-shirts needed a new way to make a living. PAGE 4

REAL ESTATE

Very Close to the Neighbors
A couple transformed a lot in Oakland, Calif., into a commune. Now, they’re selling. PAGE 9

